

INTERNSHIP REPORT

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Institution: IIM Jammu

Organization: CRY – Child Rights and You

Internship Duration: One Month

Introduction

Interning at CRY, an organisation that fights for children's rights, has changed my life and my academic career in many ways. It helped to gain hands-on experience with the ground reality and how things work in an organisation. At first, my designated domain was to intern in the Ideation and Implementation department, but because of factors out of my control, I started late, and I was given research-based tasks and later moved to the Social Media Content and Design vertical. This change, which came out of the blue, opened up new ways to learn, be creative, and find meaning in life.

Assignment 1: Child Labour and Common Consumer Goods

My internship started with an intriguing task into the hidden connections between child labour and three common household items: glasses, computers, and clothing. It's hard to imagine that everyday items like the clothes we wear, the laptops we type on, or the spectacles we see through could be linked to the stolen childhoods of millions, but they are. Children often work in unsafe glass manufacturing or inhale silica dust in sand mining to make glass. This commonly happens in Firozabad, where safety and school are hard to come by. These minerals are very important for our contemporary life. Kids sew clothes in secret workshops, giving up their dreams for long hours, little pay, and being around chemicals. We think of clothes as comfortable and a part of who we are. These aren't just supply chains; they're stories of survival, silence, and neglect by the government. This isn't meant to make you feel bad; it's meant to make you feel like you have to make better choices and make the world a fairer place.

Assignment 2: Finding Meaning in Data Mining

The second task was to look at the most recent data from NCRB, NHFS, and other trustworthy sources to find the most important issues related to children's rights in India. Child labour, child marriage, and trafficking were the three issues I focused on the most. I looked at how socio-economic instability and post-pandemic regression have made these issues worse over time, from 2015 to 2022. I learnt to see beyond numbers by doing data

research and policy gap assessments. I learnt to see them as real stories, real kids, and real cries for help.

Assignment 3: Child Rights That Made Me Think

This reflective assignment challenged me to explore the rights that personally moved me:

Right to Participate: Every child should be able to speak up and have their voice heard, not just be safe.

Right to Protection from Abuse and Violence - no child should have to deal with fear, pain, or neglect as normal.

Right to Health and Survival- because I know how scary it is to not know what's going to happen to your health.

From my own experience with a retina condition and trips to schools for blind children, I learnt that survival isn't just about staying alive; it's also about having support and opportunities.

Creativity, Design, and Purpose

I moved to the team that makes and designs content for social media halfway through my internship. There, I could be creative and have a purpose at the same time. I helped come up with a strange but useful idea for World Youth Skills Day: a "Report Card of Life Skills." This was one of the most important things I did. Instead of giving grades for schoolwork, we talked about everyday skills like dancing, telling stories, sewing, and biking, and how they could help people grow emotionally, become more independent, and feel more sure of themselves. The goal was to honour skills that are important for life but often go unnoticed. People liked it because it was new and caring. I also learnt more about how CRY helps teens and young adults get out of dangerous situations, child labour, and trafficking. They do this by teaching them how to cook, sew, use computers, and do other useful things for work. These aren't just skills; they're the first steps towards a better future, freedom, and respect. I also worked on other fun campaigns, like "Monsoon Magic" and "Back to School ." I also got to make heartfelt Christmas cards for CRY's donors to thank them. This experience taught me that stories based on empathy and real life can be just as effective as fieldwork in bringing about

Raising funds and Mentorship

I did not have any prior experience in fundraising, but was encouraged to try also I joined the fundraising effort late and didn't reach the goal, raising even a little made me feel like I was doing something meaningful with purpose. I learnt that intent can also be a way to measure impact. I also had the chance to meet mentors who told me to ask questions, think about things, and look at the big picture through this process.

Conclusion

This one-month internship was more than just an internship; it was a reflection, a direction, and a calling. It made me more efficient in the skills I already possessed and improved my communication. I got to know how things work in a real organisation and provided various networking opportunities.

I will always be thankful to CRY for giving me this chance to learn and make a difference.